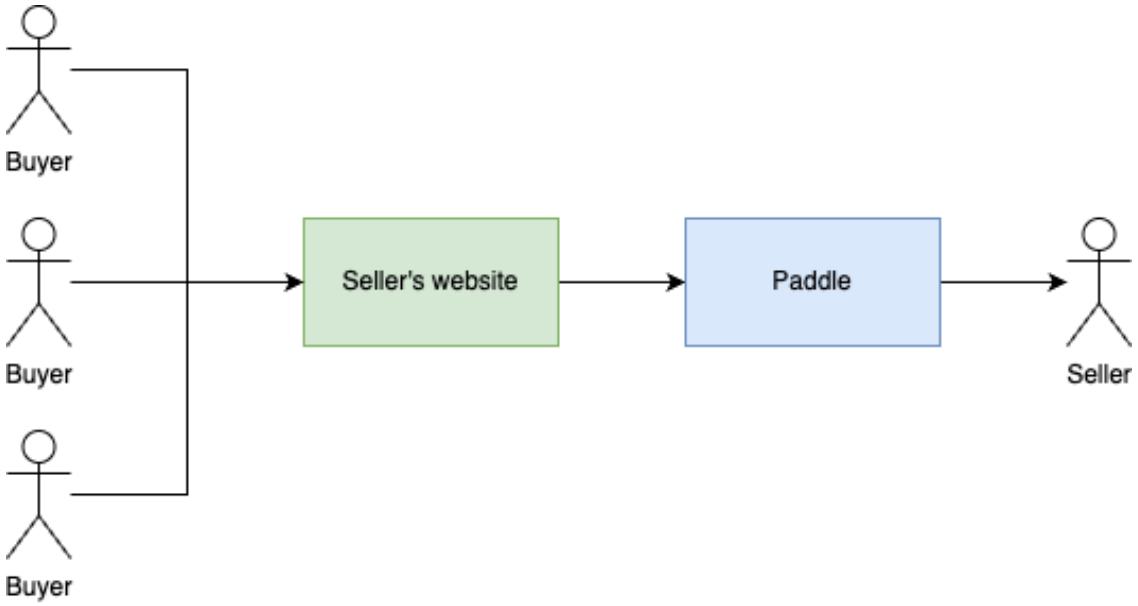
Introduction

In this book, I'd like to show you some ideas and tips that you can use in any financial-related applications of features. We're going to rebuild some features of Paddle.

Paddle is a finance application. More specifically it's a merchant of record that looks like this:



This is what's happening:

- A seller (or content creator) uploads a product to Paddle
- They integrate Paddle into their landing page
- Buyers buy the product from the landing page using a Paddle checkout form
- Paddle pays the seller every month

I personally use Paddle to sell my books and SaaS and it's a great service. The main benefit is that you don't have to deal with hundreds or thousands of invoices and VAT ramifications. Paddle handles it for you. They send an invoice to the buyer and apply the right amount of VAT based on the buyer's location. They also handle VAT ramifications. You, as the seller, don't have to deal with any of that stuff. They just send you the money once every month and you have only one invoice. It also provides nice dashboards and reports.

In this short book, I'd like to rebuild some of its core features. My experience is that there are lots of (mostly) legacy projects where dealing with money, numbers, and payments is implemented in a horrible way. Float numbers, strings, integers, calculation errors because of the decimals, inconsistency all over the place, `$29.99998` and `30.000001%` on the frontend. You know what I mean.

These are the main features we're replicating:

- Buying something from the seller. This is called a transaction.
- Triggering a webhook. Sellers can set up webhooks such as "call this URL when someone buys a product."
- Exporting transaction reports.
- Paying out sellers every month in a scheduled way based on their past transactions.